



Chapter 2

User personas

Ages 6-9 · the playground years

When the device loosens, friends become the authority, and the playground starts teaching its own lessons. The co-player is now sometimes an older sibling, not a parent. India-segmented personas so Chapter 2 grows up with the player.

The playground is the new curriculum.

Chapter 1 designed for a parent and a toddler on a sofa. Chapter 2 is a different world: the child can read a little, plays with one eye on friends, gets a first taste of their own screen, and brings home rules nobody taught them. The shallow trap also changes shape. At 3-6, shallow felt repetitive. At 6-9, anything that feels like a "baby game" is rejected on sight.

Four shifts from Chapter 1

SHIFT	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT THE DESIGN MUST DO
Peers become the authority	"That's for girls" from a classmate now outranks a parent. Gender policing peaks on the playground.	Take on peer myths directly; arm kids with comebacks and ally moves.
The co-player varies	Sometimes a supervising parent, often an older sibling, sometimes solo-but-watched.	Light-touch setup, no adult account required, a teen-sibling mode.
First screen-life	YouTube, games, ads, strangers. They are online before they are ready for it.	Concrete media and online-safety literacy; no purchase mechanics.
"I'm not a baby"	6-9s want to feel grown-up; toddler aesthetics get abandoned in seconds.	Step up the challenge, the look, and the respect; choices over labels.

Eight personas again, three Indian segments, three roles. Each ends in design implications for the eight Chapter 2 games: Body Lab Juniors, What Makes Me Me, Safety Squad, Friend or Frenemy, Fair Play World, Not Fair Not Funny, Smart Screen Heroes, and Heart Smart.

More rooms, more voices.

The home segments mirror Chapter 1, but the cast grows up: a teen sibling now appears as a real guardian, and the educators move from preschool to primary school.

PERSONA	ROLE	SEGMENT	IN ONE LINE	THE LEVER FOR DEPTH
Aditi Menon, 36	Parent	Metro, dual-income	Negotiating the first device and YouTube.	Earn the screen; survive his friends.
Pooja Verma, 34	Parent	Tier-2, joint family	School says "anything", home says "serve tea".	Back the daughter without a house war.
Sana, 14	Guardian (sibling)	Low-income	Minds her 7-year-old brother after school.	Design for the teen mediator.
Reyansh, 7	Child	Metro	Wants what his friends have; YouTube-fluent.	Grown-up feel; comebacks for peer myths.
Ananya, 8	Child	Tier-2	Sharp on fairness; clocks the home double standard.	Dilemmas and agency, not labels.
Faizan, 7	Child	Low-income	Gentle, "different", gets teased.	Belonging; protect and affirm.
Mrs. Pillai, 44	Educator	Urban primary school	35 kids, exams, playground disputes.	Group mode; teacher-safe framing.
Deepak, 29	Educator	Govt / NGO primary	Multi-grade, multilingual, few devices.	Offline, multilingual, FLN-aligned.

SUPERVISOR & GATEKEEPER

Aditi Menon, 36

Marketing lead · Pune · nuclear family · son Reyansh, 7 (Class 2)

"He learned more from a YouTuber last week than I'd like to admit. I want something that earns the screen and survives his friends' opinions."

HOME	Nuclear, Pune. Aditi, husband, son Reyansh (7).
LANGUAGES	English at home, Marathi around; he reads early.
DEVICES	Reyansh's own tablet (time-limited), her phone.
SCHOOL	Good private school; after-school classes.
MONEY	Comfortable; pays for quality, hates being nagged for purchases.

A Saturday. Reyansh has been deep in YouTube and wants Roblox "because everyone in class has it". He repeats a line she does not love: "that's a girls' game". She no longer sits and co-plays the way she did when he was four; she supervises from across the room. She wants to redirect him to something with values, but it cannot feel like homework, and it absolutely cannot feel like a "baby app", or he is gone in seconds.

What she wants

- Screen time that visibly earns its place and is not babyish.
- Something that counters what he picks up from YouTube and the playground.
- Light-touch for her: he can play mostly solo while she keeps half an eye.
- A safe, sane first taste of being online.

Why she'd bounce

- It looks like a toddler app; he calls it "baby stuff" and quits.
- It is the same tap-the-card loop, just older art.
- It nags for coins, gems or purchases like his other games.

BORING TO REYANSH (AND SO, TO ADITI)

A cutesy, toddler-pitched game. He abandons it in twenty seconds and asks for Roblox.

The bias she models

Progressive but busy. YouTube does a lot of the babysitting; the algorithm hands him gendered, competitive, buy-this content. She praises winning and being "tough", and lets "boy" defaults slide.

That's a girls' game.
Winning is what counts.

She wants help countering the feed, not another thing competing with it for his attention.

MAGIC TO ADITI

He comes back from school having told a friend "anyone can play with anything" - and used a comeback the game gave him.

Design implications

- 1 Pitch up from Chapter 1: maturer art, real challenge, a "this is not a baby game" feel from the first screen.
- 2 Build for light-touch supervision: mostly solo play with a short, optional parent check-in, not constant co-play.
- 3 Arm him for the playground: give shareable "comebacks" to peer myths he can actually use at school.
- 4 Model safe online behaviour and keep it purchase-free; never use coins, gems or upsells.

OPERATOR & BRIDGE

Pooja Verma, 34

Homemaker · Jaipur · joint family · daughter Ananya, 8 (Class 3)

"At school she learns she can be anything. At home she's learning to serve tea. I'm caught in the middle, and so is she."

HOME	Joint family: husband, his parents, son (11), daughter Ananya (8).
LANGUAGES	Hindi at home; English-medium school; Ananya reads both, slowly.
DEVICES	One shared Android; a rationed data pack.
CARE	Local English-medium school; grandparents at home.
MONEY	Single income; careful; value for money.

After school. Ananya asks why she is called to help in the kitchen while her older brother is not. Dadi says "that is how it is". Pooja agrees with her daughter privately but cannot be seen to overturn the elders. A cousin recently started her period and Ananya has questions; Pooja wants to prepare her, gently, without scandal in a shared house.

What she wants

- Fair, modern ideas for her daughter, framed so the elders do not object.
- Respectful early body and period preparation she can stand behind.
- Short, supervisable sessions on the shared phone.
- Her daughter to keep her spark and her questions.

Why she'd bounce

- Anything that reads as attacking the family or "the culture".
- Body content with no framing she can defend to dadi.
- English-only screens her mother-in-law cannot vet.

BORING (AND RISKY) TO POOJA

A preachy "gender equality" game she would never play within earshot of her mother-in-law.

The bias in the room

The household's more than hers. Boys served first, girls' chores, "good girls stay quiet", modesty policing. Ananya is starting to notice, and to mind.

Cooking and cleaning are girls' work.

Good girls don't argue.

Pooja wins when the product hands her cover and language, not a confrontation.

MAGIC TO POOJA

A fairness game framed as "everyone in a family helps" that dadi nods along to, while Ananya sees her chores were never a law of nature.

Design implications

- 1 Frame fairness and body topics in family-safe language an elder can accept and a parent can defend.
- 2 Handle early-puberty and period prep as health, gated for the ~8-9 girl band, with a parent on-ramp.
- 3 Ship bilingual: regional-language narration and labels so the whole household can vet it.
- 4 Support sibling and cousin turn-taking on one device, so the product itself models fairness.

TEEN SIBLING MEDIATOR

Sana, 14

Class 9 student · peri-urban · minds her brother Faizan, 7, after school

"Ammi works till night, so the phone and Faizan are both mine after school. I want him to learn good things, not just watch fight videos."

HOME	One room; both parents work long hours; Sana is in charge after 3pm.
LANGUAGES	Urdu / Hindi; some English; Sana reads well, Faizan is just starting.
DEVICES	One shared phone (hers and her mother's); tight data.
CARE	Faizan in a government primary school; Sana supervises homework and play.
MONEY	Daily-wage household; every rupee and megabyte counts.

3:30pm, most days. Sana gets home, does her own homework, and watches Faizan. She decides what he plays and watches; she is his teacher, protector and playmate at once. She worries about what he stumbles onto online, and that boys at school tease him. She is also fourteen, with her own phone habits and her own half-formed ideas about how boys and girls "should" be.

What she wants

- Something safe and genuinely good for Faizan that she can trust and set up fast.
- An app that runs on almost no data while she studies beside him.
- Content that is right for a 7-year-old but not embarrassing for her to be seen with.
- Help knowing what to do when he is teased or sees something he should not.

Why she'd bounce

- Online-only or data-hungry; it dies on their pack.
- Needs a literate adult or an account to start.
- Too babyish, too long, or it talks down to both of them.

UNUSABLE TO SANA

An app that needs a parent login, a steady connection, and a fat download. None of that exists here.

The bias she carries (and is unlearning)

She is a teenager absorbing the same online gender scripts. She might tell Faizan to "stop being a girl" or police his liking for pink, even as she fiercely protects him. Equip her, and she becomes his best ally.

Boys who like pink are weird.

Just ignore it and they'll stop.

Reaching the teen mediator is the generational loop in miniature: she carries what she learns into how she raises the next child.

MAGIC TO SANA

An offline pack she sets up in ten seconds; Faizan plays while she studies, and it nudges her to back him up the next time he is teased.

Design implications

- 1 Design for the teen-sibling mediator: ten-second setup, no adult account, offline, very low data.
- 2 Reach the mediator too: short moments that speak to the teen guardian, not only the child, so values travel up a generation.
- 3 Protect the teased younger child and give the older one concrete ally moves.
- 4 Keep sessions short, complete and self-respecting, for a child and a busy teenager sharing one screen.

THE LEARNER

Reyansh, 7

Metro · peer-and-screen driven · "the little expert"

"My friend said that's for girls. Everyone knows that."

Where he is, developmentally

- Reads early but still prefers to be told and shown; attention 12-15 minutes if it is challenging.
- Peer-driven: what classmates say outranks what parents say.
- Competitive; loves being the expert and being a bit grown-up.
- Fluent in YouTube and game culture; repeats catchphrases and ad lines.
- Polices "cool / not cool" and "boy / girl" hard, because his friends do.

BORING TO REYANSH

Anything cutesy or slow. "This is for babies." Closed, back to Roblox.

What he's absorbing. Reyansh now sorts the world by what the playground and his feed approve of. "That's for girls", "that's lame", "I won, you lost". He is not unkind; he is conforming, hard, because belonging is everything at seven. The good news: the same social wiring that spreads a myth will spread a comeback.

MAGIC TO REYANSH

A game that treats him as capable, lets him make real choices, and hands him a line that wins the argument at school tomorrow.

Design implications

- 1 Respect his age: maturer tone and visuals, real difficulty, no toddler cues.
- 2 Channel competition into fairness: make "is that fair?" the contest, not just "who is fastest".
- 3 Give him social currency: comebacks and cool ways to be the kid who includes everyone.
- 4 Meet his media life head-on: spot the ad, spot the fake, question the feed.

THE LEARNER

Ananya, 8

Tier-2 · justice-seeker · "the one who notices"

"Why does bhaiya get to play while I help? That's not fair."

Where she is, developmentally

- Fierce, maturing sense of fairness; she argues from principle now, not just impulse.
- Early bilingual reader; loves stories, decisions and being trusted.
- Notices the gap between school ("be anything") and home ("girls' work").
- Sensitive to belonging and teasing; wants to be liked and to be right.
- Empathy is strong; she will fight for a wronged character.

BORING (OR OFF-PUTTING) TO ANANYA

Being told the one right answer with a buzzer. She wanted to reason it out, and to be heard.

What she's absorbing, and resisting. Ananya is being taught that good girls are quiet, helpful and do not make a fuss. Part of her is complying; part of her is starting to push back, and she does not yet have the words. Give her language and a game that takes her side, and she becomes the most engaged player in the house.

MAGIC TO ANANYA

A dilemma where she decides what is fair, the game backs her up, and she finally has words for the unfairness she feels at home.

Design implications

- 1 Lead with dilemmas and agency: let her decide and reason, do not just ask her to label the right card.
- 2 Validate the questions she already has; take her side on everyday unfairness.
- 3 Give her language she can carry home for the double standards she notices.
- 4 Stay gentle on "wrong"; reward the thinking, not just the answer.

THE LEARNER

Faizan, 7

Low-income · gentle, "different" · "the one being teased"

"They said boys can't like pink. So I stopped saying it's my favourite."

Where he is

- Gentle, imaginative; drawn to colours, stories and things the playground codes "girly".
- Teased and sometimes left out; his confidence at school is dropping.
- Raised in the afternoons by his sister; she is his safest person.
- Reading is just starting; he understands far more than he can decode.
- Beginning to shrink himself to avoid the teasing.

PAINFUL TO FAIZAN

A loud, competitive, boy-versus-girl game. It is the playground that hurts him, rebuilt on a screen.

What the playground is teaching him. Faizan is learning that being different is unsafe, and that the fix is to hide. This is the exact age where that lesson hardens or gets interrupted. A game cannot stop the teasing, but it can be one place where he is completely fine as he is, and it can quietly recruit the kids around him as allies.

MAGIC TO FAIZAN

A calm world where "what makes me me" is the whole point, a character stands up for someone like him, and a trusted grown-up (his sister, his teacher) has his back.

Design implications

- 1 Affirm identity beyond gender; never split the world into "boy stuff" and "girl stuff".
- 2 Model the ally: show bystanders stepping in, and let the player practise it, so his classmates learn it too.
- 3 Widen "trusted grown-up" to include an older sibling and a teacher, the adults he actually has.
- 4 Default to calm and no-fail; make belonging, not winning, the reward.

FACILITATOR

Mrs. Pillai, 44

Class 2-3 teacher · urban school · 35 children, one screen, a syllabus to finish

"Give me five clean minutes for circle time, and a way to teach 'safe and unsafe' that no parent can complain about."

Her reality

- 35 children, exam and syllabus pressure, very little spare time or prep.
- Playground disputes, teasing and "he touched my things" all land on her.
- Cautious about "sensitive" topics; fears parent backlash, but is the legal safety net (POCSO).
- Trusted by parents; her word travels home.

What she needs from SwipeEd. Not 35 tablets. A five-minute, value-of-the-week tool for the class screen: one dilemma or one safety idea, the children vote or come up to tap, a clean pause, and a short note home so parents continue it. Crucially, she needs body-safety framed so it is defensible to the most conservative parent in the room.

USELESS TO HER

A single-player app needing 35 logins and headphones. It cannot survive her classroom or her timetable.

MAGIC TO HER

One screen, a "what would you do?" the class debates in five minutes, a parent-safe safety message, and a one-tap note home.

Design implications

- 1 Offer a group / projector mode for a class of 35, with whole-class voting and big visuals.
- 2 Fit the timetable: five-minute, zero-prep slots; interruptible and resumable.
- 3 Make safety teacher-safe: parent-defensible framing plus a short "why this is safe to teach" note.
- 4 Give her a quiet way to flag a worrying response and a one-tap parent bridge.

FACILITATOR

Deepak, 29

Government / NGO primary facilitator · multi-grade, multilingual classroom

"My class is three grades and three languages, and the power comes and goes. Build for that, or it never gets used."

His reality

- One multi-grade room (roughly 6-9 together), several home languages.
- A foundational-literacy mandate (NIPUN Bharat / FLN) and almost no devices.
- Unreliable power and data; one shared tablet at most.
- Low parental involvement; safety and hygiene are urgent, daily concerns.

UNUSABLE TO HIM

An online-only, English-only app. It fails at the first outage and leaves half the class out.

What he needs from SwipeEd. Offline content that runs with no signal, narration in the children's language, and pictures that carry the meaning so reading level is never a barrier. He reaches exactly the children that English-first, online-first edtech never touches, but only if it survives a power cut and a mixed-age group.

MAGIC TO HIM

An offline, regional-language pack he runs for a mixed-age group, building early reading, safety and fairness at once.

Design implications

- 1 Offline-first and light on power and data; one shared device, no accounts.
- 2 Multilingual narration and picture-led design so reading level is never a gate.
- 3 Map to foundational literacy and life-skills so it counts as curriculum, not extra.
- 4 Make it multi-grade friendly: the same node works across the 6-9 range.

What Chapter 2 must do differently.

Across all eight personas, the same levers recur. They are what turn "boring, repetitive and shallow" into something a screen-savvy seven-year-old, a justice-seeking eight-year-old and a stretched primary teacher all keep coming back to.

PRINCIPLE	BECAUSE	SHOWS UP AS
Grow up with the player	6-9s reject anything "babyish" on sight; toddler design is the new shallow.	Maturer art, real challenge, respect from the first screen.
Design for a variable co-player	The operator is now a supervising parent, a teen sibling, or a teacher.	Ten-second setup, no adult account, sibling and group modes.
Take on the playground	Peers, not parents, now enforce "that's for girls" and who's left out.	Bystander dilemmas, peer-myth busting, shareable comebacks.
Choices over labels	Fairness and reasoning, not "tap the right one", is the engine at this age.	Branching "what would you do?", and the game takes the child's side.
First screen-life literacy	They are on YouTube and games before they are ready for ads and strangers.	Spot-the-ad, real-vs-fake, safe-online beats; zero purchase mechanics.
Reading as scaffold, not gate	Early, uneven readers across two languages.	Audio default, optional bilingual read-along, picture-led meaning.
Belonging is the reward	The teased, "different" child is made or broken at this age.	Identity affirmed, inclusion as the win, a calm no-fail option.
Family- and classroom-safe	Elders and teachers must be able to accept and defend it.	Safe framing, parent and teacher notes, gated period prep.

The same principles, on the eight Chapter 2 games

GAME	THE DEPTH MOVE FROM THESE PERSONAS
Body Lab Juniors (g06)	Privacy and early body changes (esp. for ~9-year-old girls), framed as health; concrete enough for sibling-led play.
What Makes Me Me (g07)	Identity beyond gender; protective for the teased, "different" child; busts the playground's "boy / girl" rules.
Safety Squad (g08)	Peer and first-online safety; "trusted grown-up" widened to sibling and teacher; POCSO-aligned, teacher-defensible.
Friend or Frenemy (g09)	The core 6-9 drama: best friends, exclusion, "you can't play with us"; practising repair and inclusion.
Fair Play World (g10)	Fairness as dilemma, not label; takes the justice-seeker's side on home double standards.
Not Fair, Not Funny (g11)	Teasing and the bystander; concrete ally moves for the child who teases and the one teased.

Smart Screen Heroes (g12)

First screen-life literacy: ads, real-vs-fake, strangers; meets Reyansh where his feed already lives.

Heart Smart (g41)

Empathy and perspective-taking: "how does she feel?"; emotional vocabulary the playground does not teach.

Next: the same persona lens for Chapters 3-8, or a Chapter 2 game-by-game redesign built on this brief.